

sliders for various editing attributes. The software is built around the idea of a photographic developing room, where organisation of stills and video is just as much important as the editing itself. Professional photographers can end up taking thousands of photographs daily due to the convenience of digital photography and Lightroom is built to manage these photographs and assist users to make large batch edits quickly and cleanly. The software also includes output automation where photographs can be exported as dynamic websites and slideshows at the push of a button.

Lightroom is a better tool for multimedia editing since it is a truly reflection of video stylings. Concepts like colour temperature, colour grading, vignetting, lens correction and other essential aspects are complementary to film editing and can be easily learnt in Lightroom. The similar tools in video editing make the learning curve easy while the inclusion of images in video becomes child's-play due to the similar terminology and features. The newer versions of Lightroom also allow basic video editing in terms of image quality and are fun to experiment with given how fast and smoothly the software is able to make the changes.

Professional vs. Casual Editing

Having gotten a broad overview of the largest and most popular multimedia editing tools available we are now in a better position to discuss what is the right tool for you. The answer to this question comes from the needs and ambitions of individual users. For independent filmmakers who want to really try and make a film using low-end cameras as seen in movies like Paranormal Activity, The Dirties, Monsters and Chronicle then it's highly recommended that you invest in the Adobe Premier Pro, After Effects and Audition package since it will allow you to create high quality cinematic footage from low resolution footage on an affordable monthly rate.

If you wish to start a career in filmmaking where you are likely to direct or produce films then the very least option becomes Adobe Premier Pro (or Final Cut Pro if you already have an Apple machine) with the eventual goal of mastering Avid Media Composer. But if you just wish to edit the videos you make with your regular handy cam or mobile device for polished home movies then it's just of figuring out if the cost of Adobe or Apple seem affordable to you. The free options don't give you all the effects but get a lot done and we shall be discussing them in later chapters. 